# The Legend of Sargon, King of Agade – King 1907, vol. II, Appendix I (pp. 87–96)

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**Col. I (K 3401 + Sm 2118, with K 4470 col. I and BM 47449)** ..... **2**

**Col. II (K 4470 col. II)** ..... **5**



L. W. King, *Chronicles concerning Early Babylonian Kings, including records of the early history of the Kassites and
the country of the sea*, vol. II: *Texts and Translations* (Studies in Eastern History III; London: Luzac, 1907),
Appendix I, "The Legend of Sargon, King of Agade. [K. 3401 + S. 2118, K. 4470, and No. 47449.]". Public domain.


**Transcribed by hand from the page images** (`page-images/p087.png` … `p096.png`, rendered from the PDF in this
folder), 2026-10-21, **not** from the PDF's OCR layer (which garbles the cuneiform type and many readings). King's
cuneiform type is not reproduced; his transliteration, his translation and his footnotes are given exactly, line by
line, in modern Unicode:

- King's superscript determinatives are written in braces: `{m}` (personal name), `{amêlu}` (LÚ), `{ālu}` (URU),
  `{nâru}` (ÍD), `{ilu}` (DINGIR), `{KI}`, `{pl}` (plural marker). The italic/roman distinction of the print is not
  kept: King prints in roman (= a logogram in the cuneiform, read by him) e.g. *šarru*, *iddî*, *bâbi*, *abi*, *aḫ*,
  *nâru*, *šanâti*, *nišê*, *šadê*, *erû*, *elûti*, *šaplûti*, *rabî(i)*, *arki*, *eli*, *Puratti*, *Dilmun*,
  *Dûr-ilu*, and the numerals *III*, *IV*. These are King's readings of logograms, not syllabic spellings.
- `ḳ` = King's q (dotted k); `â ê î û` as printed; `[ ]` restorations as printed (King: "Conjectural restorations are
  placed within brackets"); `[. . .]` / `.....` = gaps or signs King leaves unread.
- Footnote numbers are King's (renumbered per page in the print); they are given after the line they belong to.

King's statement of method (p. 87, n. 1): "In the present edition the text of Col. I is taken from the obverse of
K. 3401 + S. 2118 with restorations and variant readings from K. 4470, Col. I, and No. 47449; Col. II is taken from
the second column of K. 4470." The copies: CT 13 pl. 42 f.; earlier 3 R 4 no. 7 (K 3401); Pinches, PSBA 18 (1896)
257 (No. 47449 = BM 47449).

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## Col. I (K 3401 + Sm 2118, with K 4470 col. I and BM 47449)

**I 1** Šarru-ukîn[2] šarru dan-nu šar A-ga-de{KI} a-na-ku[3]

- King: "Sargon, the mighty king, the king of Agade, am I."
- n. 2: No. 47449 [two signs], *Šarru-ukîn*. n. 3: No. 47449 omits *a-na-ku*.

**I 2** um-mi[1] e-ni-tum a-bi ul i-di[2]

- King: "My mother was lowly, my father I knew not,"
- n. 1: No. 47449 [sign], *ummi*. n. 2: No. 47449 [signs], *abu la i-ši*, "a father I had not."

**I 3** aḫ[3] abi-ia i-ra-mi ša-da-a[4]

- King: "and the brother of my father dwelleth in the mountain."
- n. 3: No. 47449 [signs], *a-ḫu*. n. 4: No. 47449 [signs, one in brackets], *šadâ i-ra-am-mu*. In K. 3401 + S. 2118,
  ll. 2 and 3 are written in one line, divided by [a divider sign].

**I 4** a-li {ālu}A-zu-pi-ra-a-ni[5] ša i-na a-ḫi {nâru}Puratti šak-nu

- King: "My city is Azupirânu, which lieth on the bank of the Euphrates."
- n. 5: K. 4470 [signs], *{ālu}A-zu-pi-ra-nu*.

**I 5** i-ra-an-ni um-mu[6] e-ni-tum i-na pu-uz-ri u-lid-an-ni[7]

- King: "My lowly mother conceived me, in secret she brought me forth."
- n. 6: K. 4470 [signs], *um-mi*; No. 47449 [sign], *ummu*. n. 7: No. 47449 [signs], *ina pu-uz-zu u-lid-da-an-ni*;
  [*zu*] is probably a mistake of the scribe for [*ri*].

**I 6** iš-kun-an-ni i-na ḳup-pi ša šu-ri[1] i-na[2] iddî bâbi-ia ip-ḫi

- King: "She set me in a basket of rushes, with bitumen she closed my door;"
- n. 1: K. 4470 [signs], *šu-u-[ri]*; No. 47449 [signs], *iš-ku-na-an-ni ina ḳu-up-pu ša šu-u-šu*. There is a word
  *šûšu*, "sprout" or "twig," but [*šu*] is probably a mistake of the scribe for [*rî*]. n. 2: No. 47449 [sign], *ina*.

**I 7** id-dan-ni[3] a-na [nâ]ri ša la e-li-e-a

- King: "she cast me into[1] the river, which (rose) not over me."
- n. 3 (King's translation n. 1): K. 4470 [signs], *id-dan-an-ni*, "she gave me to the river."

**I 8** iš-ša-an-ni nâru a-na eli {m}Ak-ki {amêlu}nâḳ-mê u-bil-an-ni[4]
- King: "The river bore me up, unto Akki, the irrigator it carried me."
- n. 4: K. 4470 reads [signs], *u-bi-la-an-ni*.

**I 9** {m}Ak-ki {amêlu}nâḳ-mê i-na ḫi-ib-[. .]-li-[. .] lu-u[1] u-še-la-an-ni
- King: "Akki, the irrigator, with . . [. . .] lifted me out,"
- n. 1: So K. 4470; K. 3041 [sic, for 3401] + S. 2118 omits [*u*].

**I 10** {m}Ak-ki {amêlu}nâḳ-mê a-na ma-ru-ti-šu [. . . . . .] u-rab-ban[2]-ni
- King: "Akki, the irrigator, as his own son [. . . . .] reared me,"
- n. 2: K. 4470 reads [signs], *ba-an*.

**I 11** {m}Ak-ki {amêlu}nâḳ-mê a-na {amêlu} . . . . . -ti-šu lu-u [iš]-kun-[an-ni]
- King: "Akki, the irrigator, as his gardener appointed me."
- (King leaves the logogram after *{amêlu}* untransliterated in ll. 11–12; his translation "gardener" implies the reading LÚ.NU.GIŠ.SAR/KIRI$_6$ = *nukaribbu*.)

**I 12** i-na[3] {amêlu} . . . . . -ti-ia {ilu}lš-tar lu-u i-ra-man-ni-ma
- King: "While I was a gardener the goddess Ishtar loved me,"
- n. 3: K. 3401 + S. 2118 probably reads [sign], *ina*.

**I 13** [. .]IV šanâti{pl} šarru-u-ta lu-u e-pu-uš
- King: "and for [. . .]-four years I ruled the kingdom."

**I 14** [nišê]{pl} ṣalmât ḳaḳḳadi[1] lu-u a-be-el lu-u aš-[pur]
- King: "The black-headed [people]s I ruled, I gov[erned];"
- n. 1: K. 4470 [signs], *ṣal-mat ḳaḳ-ḳadi*.

**I 15** šadê[2] dannûti{pl} ina aḳ-ḳul-la-te ša erû{pl} lu-u ub-[bit]
- King: "mighty [mountain]s with axes of bronze did I des[troy]."
- n. 2: K. 4470 [. . .] [sign], *šadî*.

**I 16** [lu-u] e-dil-li ša-di-i[3] e-lu-[ti]
- King: "I bolted fast the upp[er] mountains;"
- n. 3: K. 4470 [signs], *šad-di-i*.

**I 17** [lu-u] at-ta-[nab][1]-lak-ka-ta ša-di-i šap-l[u-ti]
- King: "I burst through the low[er] mountains."

- n. 1: "It is possible that the text is corrupt and that *tab* ([sign]) has been written by mistake for *nab*
  ([sign]); otherwise we must assume the existence of an Ittatafal form of the verb. We may compare an Iftatael form
  *al-ta-tap-pa-rak-ka* (in K. 3426, Obv., l. 14, published in *Cuneiform Texts*, Pt. XIII, pl. 48); here also the
  scribe may have made a mistake, writing [signs] for [sign], which would give the regular Ifteal form
  *al-ta-ap-rak-ka*."

**I 18** [ma]-ti ti-amat lu-u al-ma-a III šanîtu
- King: "[The Country] of the Sea three times did I besiege;"

**I 19** Dilmun{KI} lu-u ik-[. . . . . .]
- King: "Dilmun did [. . . . . ]."

**I 20** [a-n]a Dûr-ilu{KI} rabî(i) [lu-u e-li] lu-u [. . . . .]
- King: "[Unto] the great Dûr-ilu [I went up], I [. . . . .]."

**I 21** [. . . . .]-ni lu u-nak-kir-ma [. . . . . ]
- King: "[. . . . .] I altered [. . . . . ]."

**I 22** [man]-nu šarru ša i-la-a arki-ia
- King: "Whatsoever king shall be exalted after me,"

**I 23** [. . . . . ]
- King: "[. . . . . ],"

**I 24** [ni]šê{pl} ṣalmât ḳaḳḳadi li-b[e-el li-iš-pur]
- King: "let him [rule, let him govern] the black-headed peoples;"

**I 25** [šadê]{pl} dannûti{pl} ina aḳ-ḳul-la-[te ša erû{pl} lib-bi-it]
- King: "mighty [mountain]s with axes [of bronze let him destroy]."

**I 26** [l]i-te-dil-li šadê{pl} elûti{pl}
- King: "Let him bolt fast the upper mountains;"

**I 27** [lit-ta-nab-lak-kat šadê{pl} šaplûti{pl}]
- King: "[let him burst through the lower mountains]."

**I 28** [m]a-ti ti-amat lil-ma-a III šanîtu
- King: "The Country of the Sea let him three times besiege;"

**I 29** [Dilmun{KI} . . . . . ]

- King: "[let Dilmun . . . . . .]."

**I 30** [a-na D]ûr-ilu{KI} rabî(i) li-li-ma [. . . . . .]
- King: "[Unto] the great Dûr-ilu let him go up, and [let him . . . .]."

**I 31** [. . . . . .] ul-tu ali-ia A-ga-[de{KI} . . . . . .]
- King: "[. . . .] from my city of Aga[de . . . .]"

**I 32** [. . . . . .] aš mul [. . . . . .]
- King: "[. . . .] . . [. . . .]"; followed by one more broken line "[. . . . . .]" (no number).

## Col. II (K 4470 col. II)

**II 1** [. . . . . .] — King: "[. . . . . .]" | u šu-[. . . . . .] — King: "and [. . . . . .]"
**II 3** ir-tap-pu-ud [. . .] — King: "There couched [a . . .]"
**II 4** u ṣabîtu is-[. . .] — King: "and a gazelle [. . .]" | iṣ-ṣu-ru ḳa-[. . .] — King: "A bird [. . .]"
**II 6** ina pân ur-si-šu[1] [. . .] — King: "Before his . . . [. . .]"
- n. 1: "The reading of the phrase is uncertain; if *ši* + *ur* may be taken as a single sign, it might possibly be
  rendered *ina limutti ḳarni-šu*."

**II 7** il-lik ša-a-[2][. . .] — King: "There came . . . [. . .]"
- n. 2: "The word here and in l. 9 may possibly be restored as *ša-a-[ru]*."

**II 8** ir-tap-pu-ud pur[imu . . .] — King: "There couched a wild ass [. . .]"
**II 9** il-lak ša-a-[. . .] — King: "There cometh . . [. . .]"
**II 10** ir-tap-pu-ud pur[imu . . .] — King: "There coucheth a [wild] ass [. . .]"
**II 11** i-ša-'u-u [. . .] — King: "There flieth [. . .]"
**II 12** IV pa-ri-i la[1] [. . .] — King: "Four mules . . [. . .]"
- n. 1: "The traces following [*la*] do not appear to be those of *mu*; otherwise the word might possibly be restored
  as *la-si-[mu-ti]*."

**II 13** ul i-lak nê[šu . . .] — King: "A lion shall not come [. . .]"
**II 14** nêšu a-ki-lu [. . .] — King: "A devouring lion [. . .]"
**II 15** [. . . . . .] la [. . .] — King: "[. . . . .] not [. . .]"
**II 16** [ir-tap-p]u-ud ina [. . .] — King: "[There couch]ed in [. . .]"
**II 17** [. . . . . .]a [. . .] — King: "[. . . . .] [. . .]"; followed by one more broken line (no number).